

Local Floer Chain Complex across Hamiltonian Bifurcation

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This talk is based on ongoing joint work with Hong-kwon Jo (SNU).

Main result. We describe the explicit changes in Conley–Zehnder indices and the Floer chain complex for generic types of Hamiltonian bifurcations.

- **Motivation and Preliminaries.**

Bifurcations, the Conley–Zehnder index, and Floer homology.

- **Classification of Hamiltonian bifurcations.**

Birth-death, period doubling, phantom kiss and emission.

- **Chain complex mutation.**

Construction of cylinders, Morse–Bott cascade counting.

Motivation

Motivation 1. Bifurcations

A **bifurcation** is, heuristically, the birth or death of periodic orbits.

Several recent works [AFvK⁺23], [AB25], [JKvK26] relate bifurcations to symplectic invariants, for example Conley–Zehnder indices, Floer-type Euler characteristics, etc.

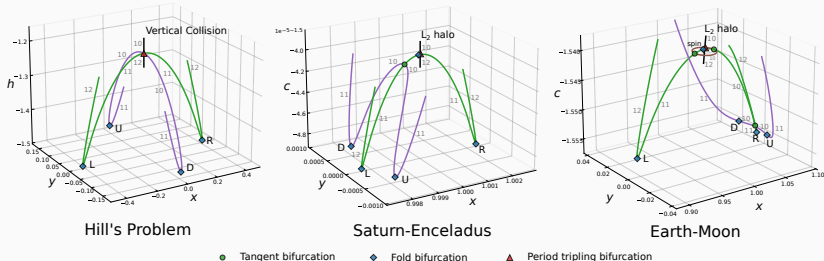


Figure 1: Bifurcation in Hill's lunar problem and CRTBP, from [JKvK26].

Meyer's classical work [Mey70] classified generic bifurcation types. Can we make a *symplectic dictionary* for these bifurcation types?

Motivation 2. Rotating Kepler Problem

In the rotating Kepler problem, there are three important periodic orbits: retrograde, direct and vertical collision orbits.

The multiple covers of the retrograde and direct orbits bifurcate, producing orbits that look like flowers.

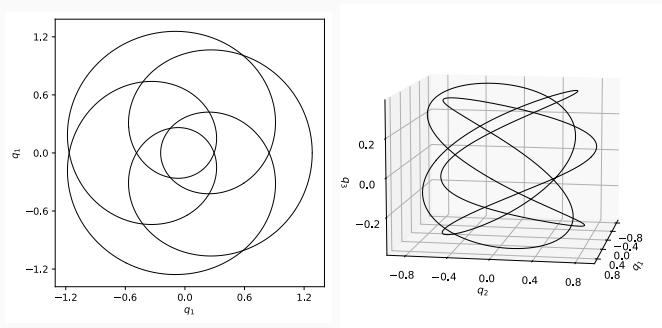
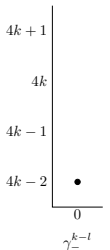
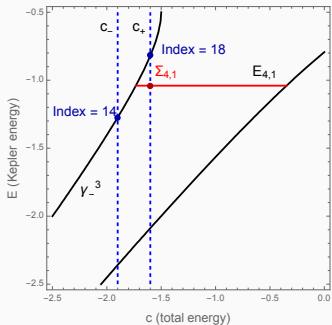


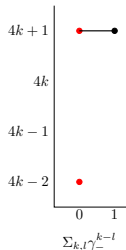
Figure 2: Resonant orbits of RKP, courtesy of Chankyu Joung.

Motivation 2. Rotating Kepler Problem

In my previous work [Lee26], I observed that this bifurcation can be translated into a change in the Floer chain complex.



At $c_{k,l}^- - \epsilon$



At $c_{k,l}^- + \epsilon$

Slogan. A bifurcation gives a *mutation of a Floer chain complex*.

We aim to describe this effect explicitly.

Preliminaries

Bifurcation

Let $H_\varepsilon : W^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a 1-parameter family of Hamiltonians, and let γ_0 be a periodic orbit of H_0 with Floquet multiplier λ_0 , an eigenvalue of the linearized return map on the Poincaré section.

If $\lambda_0 \neq 1$, so the orbit is **non-degenerate**, then nearby periodic orbits form an *orbit cylinder*

$$\Gamma = \{(\gamma_\varepsilon, \varepsilon) : \gamma_\varepsilon \text{ is a periodic orbit of } H_\varepsilon\}.$$

This is a *continuation* of the orbit along the bifurcation parameter.

If $\lambda_0 = 1$, then the orbit is degenerate, and the orbit cylinder may break:

- periodic orbits may be born or vanish; this is called a **bifurcation**,
- if $\lambda \neq 1$ but $\lambda^k = 1$, then the k -th cover bifurcates.

Example. Period Doubling

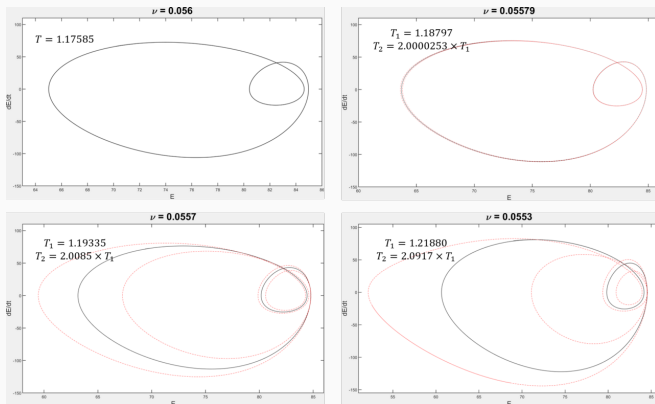


Figure 3: Period doubling in Kuramoto–Sivashinsky equation, from [Max21].

Period doubling is a generic bifurcation of a double cover.

The red dashed orbit is the new orbit that emerges from the bifurcation.

Conley–Zehnder Index

The **Conley–Zehnder index** $\mu_{\text{CZ}}(\gamma)$ is an integer associated with a periodic orbit and can be understood as a *symplectic winding number*.

We are interested in the change of the index along the parameter, say $\mu_{\text{CZ}}(\gamma_\varepsilon)$.

Along a non-degenerate family, the CZ index is constant.

Key idea. A change in μ_{CZ} = Degeneracy of γ_ε = A bifurcation occurs

Hence, a bifurcation can be detected via change of the CZ index.

(cf. [AB25], [JKvK26], etc.).

Floer Homology

Floer homology $HF(W, H)$ is a topological invariant associated with a symplectic manifold W and Hamiltonian H . (cf. [AD14].)

This is determined by the **Floer chain complex** $CF(W, H)$, whose

- generators are 1-periodic orbits of H ,
- grading is given by CZ indices,
- the differential is determined by counting **Floer cylinder**, whose boundaries are asymptotic to periodic orbits.

Across a bifurcation, $CF(W, H)$ changes substantially;

- orbits are born or vanish $\Rightarrow$ the number of generators changes.
- the CZ index changes $\Rightarrow$ grading changes

However, the homology doesn't change, so the differential is responsible for keeping the homology invariant. *Can we describe this explicitly?*

Classification of Bifurcations

Meyer's Classification

Generic Hamiltonian bifurcations are classified in [Mey70].

They are organized by the covering number k of the underlying orbit.

- $k = 1$: birth-death
- $k = 2$: period doubling, murder (opposite stability type)
- $k = 3, 4$: phantom kiss
- $k \geq 4$: emission

Aside. We will use names from [AM78].

Three extra types are given, which include critical points.

Other names: touch-and-go, period tripling/quadrupling, etc.

Birkhoff Normal Form

We find the periodic points of the iterated return map Φ_ε^k .

This can also be done in essentially the same way, by finding critical points of the generating Hamiltonian of the return maps.

1. We can write the generating Hamiltonian of the return map Φ by

$$G_t = G_2 + \sum_{k \geq 3} G_{k,t}$$

where $\deg G_k = k$, $G_2^{ss} = \alpha(u^2 + v^2)$, $\dot{G}_{k,t} = \{G_2^{ss}, G_{k,t}\}$, $\lambda = e^{i\alpha}$.

2. If $\lambda_0^k = 1$, the generating Hamiltonian of k -th iterate of the return map Φ^k can be chosen with $G_2^{ss} = 0$, so $\dot{G}_{k,t} = 0$.
3. This is defined on a *covering space* of the neighborhood of γ , which should descend to the base space to generate the first return map, which forces a symmetry of G .

Generating Hamiltonians – Birth-death

A generic single cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(u, v) = \alpha v^2 + \beta u^3 + \dots + \varepsilon(u + \dots).$$

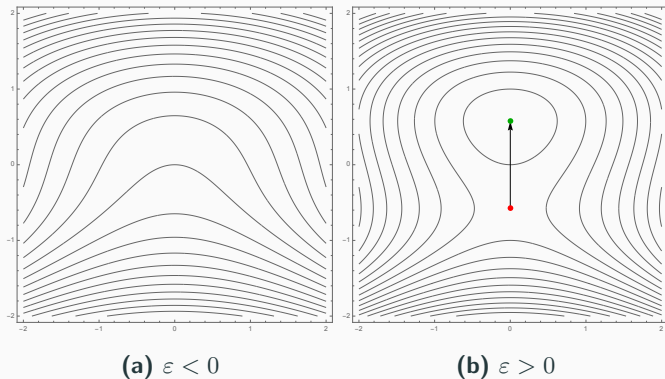


Figure 4: Critical points and gradient trajectories of birth-death bifurcation

Generating Hamiltonians – Period doubling

A generic double cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(u, v) = \alpha v^2 + \beta u^4 + \dots + \varepsilon(u + \dots).$$

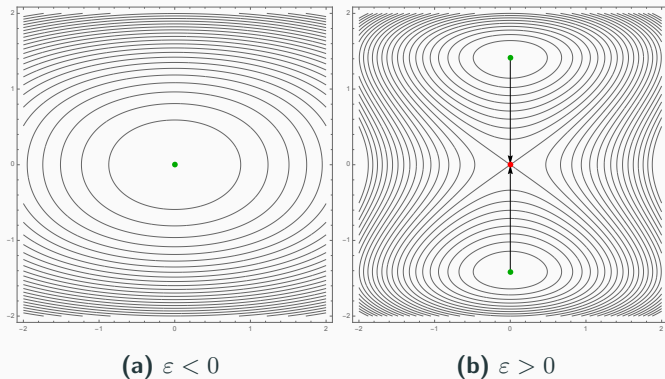


Figure 5: Period doubling bifurcation

Generating Hamiltonians – Phantom kiss

A generic 3rd or 4th cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(r, \theta) = \alpha r^k \cos k\theta + \dots + \varepsilon(r^2 + \dots).$$

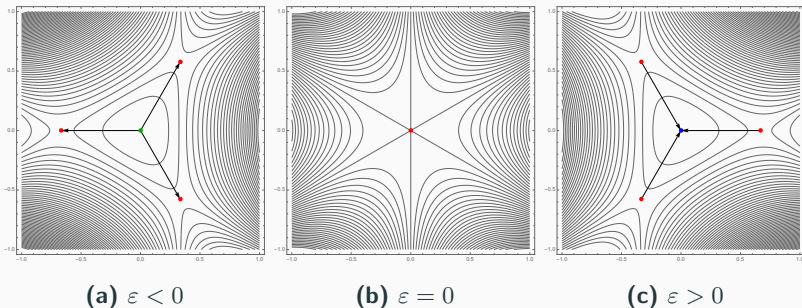


Figure 6: Phantom kiss bifurcation

Generating Hamiltonians – Emission

Generic $k \geq 4$ -th cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(r, \theta) = \alpha r^4 + \beta r^k \cos k\theta + \dots + \varepsilon(r^2 + \dots).$$

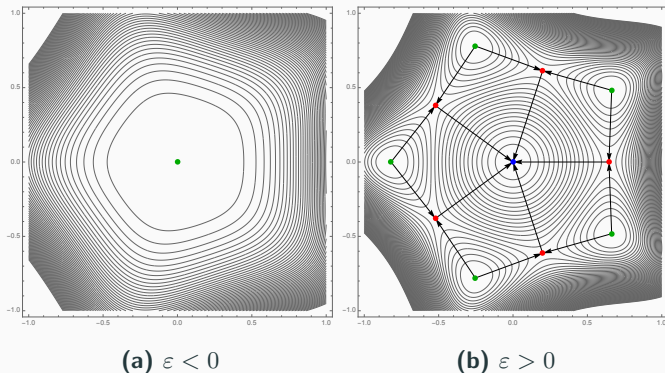


Figure 7: Emission bifurcation

Note. The fourth cover is a borderline case, depending on $|\alpha|$ and $|\beta|$.

Summary of the Classification

Name	Floquet Mult.	Before	Stability	Morse Index	After	Stability	Morse Index
Birth-death	$\lambda = 1$				γ_E	Elliptic	0 or 2
					γ_H	Hyperbolic	1
Period doubling	$\lambda = -1$	γ^2	Elliptic	0 or 2	γ^2	Hyperbolic	1
					γ_E	Elliptic	0 or 2
Murder	$\lambda = -1$	γ^2	Elliptic	0 or 2	γ^2	Hyperbolic	1
		γ_H	Hyperbolic	1			
Phantom Kiss	$\lambda^k = 1$ $k = 3, 4$	γ^k	Elliptic	0 or 2	γ^k	Elliptic	2 or 0
		γ_H	Hyperbolic	1	γ_H	Hyperbolic	1
Emission	$\lambda^k = 1$ $k \geq 4$	γ^k	Elliptic	0 or 2	γ^k	Elliptic	2 or 0
					γ_H	Hyperbolic	1
					γ_E	Elliptic	0 or 2

Table 1: Generic Hamiltonian bifurcations

Note. There are more bifurcations, e.g. pitchfork, which require extra symmetry of the system or the orbit.

Chain Complex Mutation

An easy example. Birth-death bifurcation

Suppose an orbit γ_0 experiences the birth-death bifurcation along ε .

1. If $\varepsilon < 0$, there are no orbits.
2. If $\varepsilon > 0$, there are two orbits, say γ_H and γ_E .

Floer-theoretic viewpoint.

1. If $\varepsilon < 0$, $CF = 0$.
2. If $\varepsilon > 0$, $CF = \langle \gamma_H, \gamma_E \rangle$.
3. But both cases produce the same homology.

Hence, $|\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_H) - \mu_{CZ}(\gamma_E)| = 1$ and they should cancel each other out, so there exists a Floer cylinder between them. (cf. [GG10].)

However, the situation is more complicated for higher covers.

Main Result and Key Ideas

Main result. A full description of the mutation of Floer chain complex across the five generic bifurcation types.

Key Ideas.

1. Construct a Hamiltonian H_ε represents a given bifurcation type.
2. Gradient trajectories of G_ε give Floer cylinders of H_ε .
3. We get cylinders connecting a simple orbit and a multiple cover.
 $\Rightarrow$ A contribution of 1 cylinder may not be exactly 1.

Using Morse–Bott cascades, we can compute the explicit chain complex and verify that its homology is invariant.

Adiabatic approximation of Hamiltonian

Let $\tilde{H}_\varepsilon$ be a Hamiltonian and G_ε be a generating Hamiltonian for the k -th iterate of the return map.

Using **adiabatic approximation**, which is an integration along the orbit, we construct the model Hamiltonian for each bifurcation type,

$$H_\varepsilon = h(r) + G_\varepsilon.$$

- H_ε is defined on the covering space, but Floer-type information can descend to the base space.
- H_ε is not exactly the same as $\tilde{H}_\varepsilon$, but has the same return map and Conley–Zehnder indices as $\tilde{H}_\varepsilon$.

Morse–Bott Cascade

Our periodic orbits have an S^1 -symmetry under time shifts, which makes the situation slightly different from the usual Floer theory.

We equip each orbit with a Morse function, and consider two critical points (maximum and minimum) as generators of a Floer chain complex.

In this case, the differential is given by counting **Morse–Bott cascades**; a sequence of Morse trajectories and Floer cylinders.

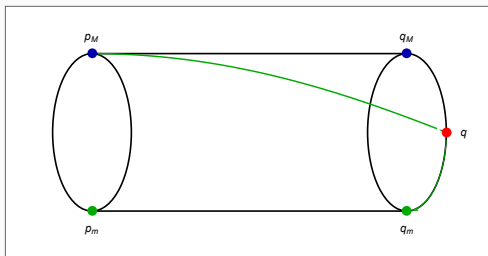


Figure 8: Morse–Bott cascade.

Chain complex mutation for Period doubling

1. If $\varepsilon < 0$, there is one orbit γ .
2. If $\varepsilon > 0$, there are two orbits; γ^2 and γ_H .
3. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma^2)$ changes, say, from N to $N - 1$.
4. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_H)$ must be N , and there exists 1 Floer cylinder between γ^2 and γ_H , whose contribution is as follows.

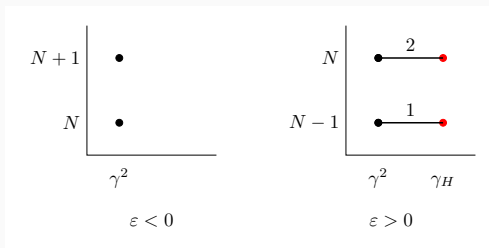


Figure 9: Chain complex mutation across the period doubling.

$\gamma_{H,\min}$ and $\gamma_{\min}^2$ cancel each other, while $\gamma_{H,\max}$ and $\gamma_{\max}^2$ do not.

Chain complex mutations for Phantom kiss and Emission

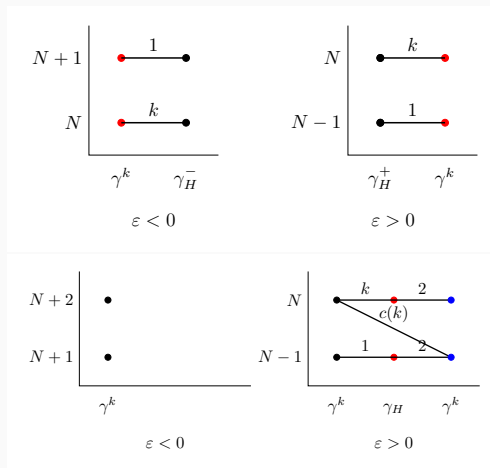


Figure 10: Chain complex mutations across phantom kiss and emission



Figure 11: Thank you for your attention!

Questions, comments, and further discussion are welcome!



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Illustration of period doubling in the Kuramoto–Sivashinsky equation. CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication.



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